

School Onboarding Playbook

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This playbook documents the working onboarding flow in the School Results system, including school reference generation, API key handling, and Excel upload credentials.

1) Prerequisites

- Admin account with access to the dashboard.
- Backend running at <http://localhost:4000> or your deployed domain.
- Excel workbook with UploadResults VBA module and CONFIG sheet.

2) Create School and Generate Reference

- Open Admin Dashboard: </admin/dashboard.html>
- Go to "Schools Onboarding".
- Enter school name and optional contact details.
- Click "Add school + generate ref".
- System generates: School Reference (SCH-XXXXXX) and School API Key (sk_...).

Important: Store the generated API key securely. It is shown at creation/regeneration time and used by the school workbook.

3) Configure Workbook Credentials

In workbook CONFIG sheet:

- B1 = ingest URL (example: <http://localhost:4000/api/excel/ingest>)
- B2 = school API key
- B3 = school reference
- B4 = school logo range on REPORT sheet (optional, e.g. A1:C6)
- B5 = student photo range on REPORT sheet (optional, e.g. I3:K10)

The VBA module sends these request headers:

X-API-Key: <school_api_key>

X-School-Ref: <school_ref>

4) Upload Flow

- Fill REPORT term/year and student data.
- Run SyncToResultsPortal / UploadResults_Click.
- Server authenticates school credentials and accepts payload.
- System upserts students/results, generates report PDFs, and links records to school_ref.

5) School Lifecycle Operations

- Copy school reference from dashboard when onboarding staff.
- Disable school to block further ingest from that school credentials.
- Regenerate API key to revoke old workbook credentials immediately.

6) Functional Validation (Executed)

The following end-to-end validation was executed in this environment:

- Created school via admin API and received generated school_ref/api_key.
- Submitted ingest payload using X-School-Ref + X-API-Key.
- Upload succeeded and produced a PDF URL.
- Verified student record contains matching school_ref.

7) Troubleshooting

- 401 Invalid school credentials: check B2/B3 values and active school status.
- 400 meta.term/year required: ensure REPORT H10/H9 are filled before sync.
- No PDF generated: inspect ingest response and server logs, then regenerate PDF from dashboard.

8) Security Notes

- Treat school API keys as secrets; rotate if exposed.
- Use HTTPS in production.
- Keep school records active only for authorized institutions.

End of playbook.